

Topic 6: Popular music	<i>Musical interpretation of lyrics through melodic, harmonic and structural means, use of technology, recording processes, performance and the interaction between voice(s) and accompaniment.</i>	
	Prescribed repertoire	Related repertoire
	The Beatles, <i>Sergeant Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band</i> (1967)	British pop music (by groups and solo artists) from the 1960s
	Queen, <i>A Night at the Opera</i> (1975)	Examples of glam rock from the 1970s; music performed by 'super groups' with international fame
	Norah Jones, <i>Not Too Late</i> (2007)	Examples of music from contemporary singer/songwriters

4.1 AS GCE Scheme of Assessment

AS GCE Music (H142)	
AS Unit G351: <i>Performing Music 1</i>	
40% of the total AS GCE marks	This examined unit has three sections:
Visiting examiner	Section A: Recital 60 marks
Approximately 17 minutes	Section B: <i>Viva voce</i> 20 marks
120 marks	Section C: Recital 40 marks
AS Unit G352: <i>Composing 1</i>	
30% of the total AS GCE marks	This coursework unit has two sections:
Coursework	Section A: The Language of Western Tonal Harmony
90 marks	45 marks
	Section B: Instrumental Techniques in Composing / Arranging
	45 marks
	Assessment Criteria: Please refer to Appendix B3 on p. 76.
AS Unit G353: <i>Introduction to Historical Study in Music</i>	
30% of the total AS GCE marks	This examined unit has three sections:
1 h 45 min (+15 minutes	Section A: Aural Extracts 30 marks
listening/preparation)	Section B: Prescribed Works 40 marks
Written paper	Section C: Contextual Awareness 20 marks
90 marks	

20% of the total Advanced
GCE marks
Visiting examiner
Approximately 20 minutes
120 marks

This examined unit has **two** sections:

Section A: Recital 100 marks

Section B: *Viva voce* 20 marks

This unit is synoptic

A2 Unit G355: *Composing 2*

15% of the total Advanced
GCE marks
Coursework
90 marks

This coursework unit has **two** sections:

Section A: Stylistic Techniques 45 marks

Section B: Composition 45 marks

Assessment Criteria: Please refer to Appendix B4 on p. 79

This unit is synoptic

A2 Unit G356: *Historical and Analytical Studies in Music*

15% of the total Advanced
GCE marks
1 h 45 min (+15 minutes
listening/preparation)
Written paper
90 marks

This examined unit has **two** sections:

Section A: Aural Extract 40 marks

Section B: Historical Topics 50 marks

This unit is synoptic

AS	G351	✓		✓
AS	G352	✓		✓
AS	G353	✓	✓	✓
A2	G354			✓
A2	G355			✓
A2	G356		✓	✓

4.7 Assessment Objectives

Candidates are expected to demonstrate the following in the context of the content described

AO1 Interpret musical ideas

- Interpret musical ideas with technical and expressive control and a sense of style and awareness of occasion and/or ensemble (*performing/realising*);

AO2 Create and develop musical ideas

- Create and develop musical ideas with technical control and expressive understanding and creative use of musical devices, conventions and resources (*composing/arranging*);

AO3 Demonstrate understanding

- Demonstrate understanding of, and comment perceptively on, the structural, expressive and contextual aspects of music (*appraising*).

Assessment of the quality of written communication will be met through AO3. Aural perception skills are assessed within all three objectives.

AO weightings in AS GCE

Unit	% of AS GCE		
	AO1	AO2	AO3
AS Unit G351: <i>Performing Music 1</i>	33.33	0	6.67
AS Unit G352: <i>Composing 1</i>	0	30	0
AS Unit G353: <i>Introduction to Historical Study in Music</i>	0	0	30
	33.33%	30%	36.67%

AO weightings in Advanced GCE

Unit	% of Advanced GCE		
	AO1	AO2	AO3
AS Unit G351: <i>Performing Music 1</i>	16.67	0	3.33
AS Unit G352: <i>Composing 1</i>	0	15	0

A2 Unit G356: <i>Historical and Analytical Studies in Music</i>	0	0	15	15%
	33.34%	30%	36.66%	100%

4.8 Quality of Written Communication

Quality of written communication is assessed in Unit G353: *Introduction to Historical Study in Music* (Section C) and Unit G356: *Historical and Analytical Studies in Music* (Sections B). Credit will be given for clear communication.

Candidates will:

- ensure that text is legible and that spelling, punctuation and grammar are accurate so that meaning is clear;
- select and use a form and style of writing appropriate to purpose and to complex subject matter;
- organise information clearly and coherently, using specialist vocabulary when appropriate.

5.1 Making Unit Entries

Please note that centres must be registered with OCR in order to make any entries, including estimated entries. It is recommended that centres apply to OCR to become a registered centre well in advance of making their first entries. Centres must have made an entry for a unit in order for OCR to supply the appropriate forms or moderator details for coursework.

It is essential that unit entry codes are quoted in all correspondence with OCR. See Sections 4.1 and 4.2 for these unit entry codes.

5.2 Making Qualification Entries

Candidates must enter for qualification certification separately from unit assessment(s). If a certification entry is **not** made, no overall grade can be awarded.

Candidates may enter for:

- AS GCE certification (entry code H142).
- Advanced GCE certification (entry code H542).

A candidate who has completed all the units required for the qualification may enter for certification either in the same examination series (within a specified period after publication of results) or at a later series.

AS GCE certification is available from June 2009.
Advanced GCE certification is available from June 2010.

5.3 Grading

All GCE units are awarded a–e. The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is awarded on the scale A–E. The Advanced GCE is awarded on the scale A–E with access to an A*. To be awarded an A*, candidates will need to achieve a grade A on their full A Level qualification and an A* on the aggregate of their A2 units. Grades are reported on certificates. Results for candidates who fail to achieve the minimum grade (E or e) will be recorded as unclassified (U or u) and this is not certificated.

Unit Scale (UMS) enables comparison of candidates' performance across units and enables candidates' scores to be put on a common scale for aggregation. The three-unit AS GCE has a total of 300 uniform marks and the six-unit Advanced GCE has a total of 600 uniform marks.

Each raw mark for each unit is converted to a uniform mark. The maximum *uniform mark* for each unit is determined by that unit's weighting in the specification. In these Music specifications the three-unit AS GCE specification has UMS weightings of 20%/15%/15%/20%/15%/15% and the six-unit Advanced GCE specification has UMS weightings of 40%/30%/30%. The raw mark grade boundaries for the three-unit AS GCE are 120/90/60/30/10/0, respectively. Each unit's *raw mark* grade boundary equals the *uniform mark* grade boundary at the same grade. Intermediate marks are converted on a pro-rata basis.

Unit uniform marks correspond to *unit* grades as follows:

Maximum Unit Uniform Mark			Unit Grade		
a	b	c	d	e	
120	120–96	95–84	83–72	71–60	59–48
90	90–72	71–63	62–54	53–45	44–36

Candidates' unit uniform marks are compared to these pre-set boundaries (see Table 1) to arrive at qualification grades.

Unit uniform marks correspond to qualification grades.

Qualification Grade				
A	B	C	D	E
300–240	239–210	209–180	179–150	149–120
600–480	479–420	419–360	359–300	299–240

Candidates achieving at least 480 UMS marks in their Advanced GCE, i.e. grade A, and at least 300 UMS in their three A2 units will receive an A* grade.

Enquiries and Appeals

In certain circumstances, a centre may wish to query the grade available to one or more candidates. A centre may submit an appeal against an outcome of such an enquiry. Enquiries about results should be made immediately following the series in which the relevant unit was taken.

For more information relating to enquiries on results and appeals, centres should consult the OCR *Guide for General Qualifications* and the document *Enquiries about Results: Information and Guidance for Centres* produced by the Joint Council. Copies of these papers can be obtained from OCR.

5.5 Shelf-life of Units

Individual unit results, prior to certification of the qualification, have a shelf-life limited only by that of the qualification.

5.6 Unit and Qualification Re-sits

There is no restriction on the number of times a candidate may re-sit each unit before entering for certification for an AS GCE or Advanced GCE.

Candidates may enter for the full qualifications an unlimited number of times.

5.7 Guided Learning Hours

AS GCE Music requires **180** guided learning hours in total.

Advanced GCE Music requires **360** guided learning hours in total.

5.8 Code of Practice/Subject Criteria/Common Criteria Requirements

These specifications comply in all respects with the revised *GCSE, GCE, GNVQ and AEA Code of Practice* as available on the QCA website, the subject criteria for GCE Music and *The Statutory Regulation of External Qualifications 2004*.

5.9 Arrangements for Candidates with Particular Requirements

For candidates who are unable to complete the full assessment or whose performance may be adversely affected through no fault of their own, teachers should consult the *Access Arrangements and Special Consideration: Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations* produced by the Joint Council. In such cases, advice should be sought from OCR as early as possible during the course.

5.10 Prohibited Qualifications and Classification Code

Candidates who enter for the OCR GCE specifications may not also enter for any other GCE specification with the certification title Music in the same examination series.

Every specification is assigned to a national classification code indicating the subject area to which it belongs.

Centres should be aware that candidates who enter for more than one GCE qualification with the same classification code will have only one grade (the highest) counted for the purpose of the School and College Achievement and Attainment Tables.

The classification code for these specifications is 7010.

5.11 Coursework Administration/Regulations

Supervision and Authentication

As with all coursework, teachers must be able to verify that the work submitted for assessment is the candidate's own work. Sufficient work must be carried out under direct supervision to allow the teacher to authenticate the coursework marks with confidence.

Submitting marks to OCR

Centres must have made an entry for a unit in order for OCR to supply the appropriate forms or moderator details for coursework. Coursework administration documents are sent to centres on the basis of estimated entries. Marks may be submitted to OCR either via Interchange, on the computer-printed Coursework Mark Sheets (MS1) provided by OCR (sending the top copy to OCR and the second copy to their allocated moderator) or by EDI (centres using EDI are asked to print a copy of their file and sign it before sending to their allocated moderator).

The deadline for the receipt of coursework marks is:

15 May for the June series.

The awarding body must require centres to obtain from each candidate a signed declaration that authenticates the coursework they produce as their own. For regulations governing coursework, centres should consult the *OCR Administration Guide for General Qualifications*. Further copies of the coursework administration documents are available on the OCR website (www.ocr.org.uk).

Standardisation and Moderation

All internally-assessed coursework is marked by the teacher and internally standardised by the centre. Marks must be submitted to OCR by the agreed date, after which postal moderation takes place in accordance with OCR procedures.

The purpose of moderation is to ensure that the standard for the award of marks in internally-assessed coursework is the same for each centre, and that each teacher has applied the standards appropriately across the range of candidates within the centre.

The sample of work which is submitted to the moderator for moderation must show how the marks have been awarded in relation to the marking criteria.

Minimum Coursework Required

If a candidate submits no work for a unit, then the candidate should be indicated as being absent from that unit on the coursework mark sheets submitted to OCR. If a candidate completes any work at all for that unit then the work should be assessed according to the criteria and marking instructions and the appropriate mark awarded, which may be zero.

Overlap with other Qualifications

Some overlap with OCR Advanced GCE Performing Arts:

Unit G382: Performance

Unit G386: Producing Your Showcase

Progression from these Qualifications

Level specification provides a full foundation for study at higher education level, including polytechnics and universities.

Key Skills Mapping

Level specifications provide opportunities for the development of the Key Skills of *Communication of Number, Information Technology, Working with Others, Improving Own Learning and Problem Solving* at Levels 2 and/or 3. However, the extent to which the qualification fulfils the Key Skills criteria at these levels will be totally dependent on the teaching and learning adopted for each unit.

The following table indicates where opportunities *may* exist for at least some coverage of the Key Skills criteria at Levels 2 and/or 3 for each unit.

C				AoN			IT			WwO			IoLP		
.1a	.1b	.2	.3	.1	.2	.3	.1	.2	.3	.1	.2	.3	.1	.2	.3
✓		✓					✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
✓	✓	✓					✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	✓	✓					✓								
✓		✓					✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
							✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

6.4 Spiritual, Moral, Ethical, Social, Legislative, Economic and Cultural Issues

These specifications offer opportunities which can contribute to an understanding of these issues in the following topics:

When candidates engage in any of the musical activities required in these specifications, whatever the nature of their individual skill or repertoire, they need to consider what the music is 'about' – what it sets out to communicate. Answering this question may lead to others involving moral or ethical issues and about social and cultural understanding. A composer's or performer's intentions in their music-making may spring from personal beliefs, mind-set, life-style or other cultural factors. Interpreting 'meaning' in music raises questions about its expressive power which may include consideration of its *rôle* in the expression of beliefs and as a moral force.

6.5 Sustainable Development, Health and Safety Considerations and European Developments

These specifications support these Health and Safety considerations and European Developments, consistent with current EU agreements, in the following units:

Unit G351: Performing Music 1 and Unit G354: Performing Music 2 (Interpretation).

However, there are no sustainable development issues in these specifications.

6.6 Avoidance of Bias

OCR has taken great care in preparation of these specifications and assessment materials to avoid bias of any kind.

6.7 Language

These specifications and associated assessment materials are in English only.

6.8 Disability Discrimination Act Information Relating to these Specifications

AS/A Levels often require assessment of a broad range of competences. This is because they are general qualifications and, as such, prepare candidates for a wide range of occupations and higher level courses.

The revised AS/A Level qualification and subject criteria were reviewed to identify whether any of the competences required by the subject presented a potential barrier to any disabled candidates. If this was the case, the situation was reviewed again to ensure that such competences were included only where essential to the subject. The findings of this process were discussed with disability groups and with disabled people.

Reasonable adjustments are made for disabled candidates in order to enable them to access the assessments. For this reason, very few candidates will have a complete barrier to any part of the assessment. Information on reasonable adjustments is found in Access Arrangements and Special Consideration Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations produced by the Joint Council (refer to Section 5.9 of this specification).

Candidates who are still unable to access a significant part of the assessment, even after exploring all possibilities through reasonable adjustments, may still be able to receive an award. They would be given a grade on the parts of the assessment they have taken and there would be an indication on their certificate that not all of the competences have been addressed. This will be kept under review and may be amended in the future.

Candidates with hearing impairments may be restricted when required to demonstrate aural perception skills.

Students with a hearing impairment may show aural perception by interpretation of a music score rather than actually listening to the music but would not be able to assess performance of the music.

Performing has been broadened to become performing/realising. This means that candidates with a physical impairment may do a 'performance' using computer-generated sounds.

Performance descriptions have been created for all GCE subjects. They describe the learning outcomes and levels of attainment likely to be demonstrated by a representative candidate performing at the A/B and E/U boundaries for AS and A2.

In practice, most candidates will show uneven profiles across the attainments listed, with strengths in some areas compensating in the award process for weaknesses or omissions elsewhere. Performance descriptions illustrate expectations at the A/B and E/U boundaries of the AS and A2 as a whole; they have not been written at unit level.

Grade A/B and E/U boundaries should be set using professional judgement. The judgement should reflect the quality of candidates' work, informed by the available technical and statistical evidence. Performance descriptions are designed to assist examiners in exercising their professional judgement. They should be interpreted and applied in the context of individual specifications and their associated units. However, performance descriptions are not designed to define the content of specifications and units.

The requirement for all AS and A Level specifications to assess candidates' quality of written communication will be met through one or more of the assessment objectives.

The performance descriptions have been produced by the regulatory authorities in collaboration with the awarding bodies.

Descriptions for Music

Assessment Objective 1	Assessment Objective 2	Assessment Objective 3
Candidates should be able to: - interpret musical ideas with technical and expressive control and a sense of style and awareness of occasion and/or ensemble.	Candidates should be able to: - develop musical ideas with technical and expressive control making creative use of musical devices and conventions.	Candidates should be able to: - demonstrate understanding of, and perceptively on, the structural, expressive and contextual aspects of music.
Candidates characteristically: a) present musically convincing and generally fluent performances that show musical understanding.	Candidates characteristically: a) produce coherent compositions that show an ability to manipulate musical ideas, and make use of musical devices and conventions in relation to the chosen genre, style and tradition.	Candidates characteristically: a) make critical judgements about music heard and show a breadth of understanding across the genres, styles and traditions studied.
Candidates characteristically: a) perform with a sense of continuity using appropriate tempi and showing some understanding of the music chosen.	Candidates characteristically: a) produce compositions that make some use of musical ideas and show some understanding of musical devices and conventions in relation to the chosen genre, style and tradition.	Candidates characteristically: a) comment on music heard showing understanding across the genres and traditions studied.

e descriptions for Music

Assessment Objective 1	Assessment Objective 2	Assessment Objective 3
Candidates should be able to: - interpret musical ideas with technical and expressive control and a sense of style and awareness of occasion and/or ensemble.	Candidates should be able to: - develop musical ideas with technical and expressive control making creative use of musical devices and conventions.	Candidates should be able to: - demonstrate understanding of, and comment perceptively on, the structural, expressive and contextual aspects of music.
Candidates characteristically: a) present musically convincing and fluent performances that show musical understanding and personal interpretation.	Candidates characteristically: a) produce musically convincing compositions that show musical imagination, and make effective use of musical devices and conventions in relation to the chosen genre, style and tradition	Candidates characteristically: a) make and justify personal judgements on music heard and show some depth of understanding within the genres, styles and traditions studied making connections between the structural, expressive and contextual aspects of music.
Candidates characteristically: a) present generally fluent performances showing some understanding of the overall shape, direction and style of the music chosen.	Candidates characteristically: a) produce compositions that make creative use of musical ideas and show understanding of musical devices and conventions in relation to the chosen genre, style and tradition.	Candidates characteristically: a) comment in some detail on music heard, showing some understanding across the genres, styles and traditions studied.